governments in Florida, New York and New Jersey where they operated, and official investigations of their operations were mysteriously bogged down again and again. “In the Dade County police department,” wrote *Village Voice* reporter Jeff Stein in 1980, after conducting an investigation of the Cuban exile organization Omega 7, “terrorism experts exchange smiles and look down at their hands when you ask them if the CIA’s involved with exile Cuban anti Castro activities. They look to each other to answer first, clear their throats, shift in their seats. The answer is yes.” Omega 7 claimed responsibility for over 20 bombings in New York City and New Jersey in the late 1970s, targeting primarily foreign diplomats and Cuban immigrants who did not follow their hard line against the Revolution.[82]

Omega 7 was an offshoot of the umbrella organization CORU (Comando de Organizaciones Revolucionarios Unidos), which also took credit for the October 1976 bombing of Cubana Airlines Flight 455, which killed all 73 passengers. CORU was founded in June 1976 at a meeting in the Dominican Republic, and pulled together members of the Brigade 2506 and numerous other smaller exile organizations. John Dinges and Saul Landau, who researched the organization as part of their investigation into the car-bombing which killed Chilean diplomat Orlando Letelier and Institute for Policy Studies researcher Ronni Moffit in late 1976, interviewed many of those involved regarding the extent of U.S. government involvement with CORU and concluded that CORU operated with at least tacit, and in some cases direct, support from both the CIA and the FBI. “One source, a veteran of the Miami police’s fight against terrorism, said, ‘The Cubans held the CORU meeting at the request of the CIA. The Cuban groups – the FNLC, Alpha 66, Cuban Power – were running amok in the mid-1970s, and the United States had lost control of them. So the United States backed the meeting to get them all going in the same direction again, under United States control. The basic signal was ‘Go ahead and do what you want, *outside* the United States’.”[83]

Terrorist attacks on Cuban targets both inside and outside of the United States mushroomed after the founding of CORU. Besides the 1976 Cubana bombing, these included attacks against other Cuban